

U.S. Internet

Charts Worth a Look: Measuring the Current AI Uptick

Google's recent disclosures point to a steeper uptick in growth for the AI industry, with API token growth of +60% Q/Q in 1Q and daily tokens generated up to 23T. We view these metrics as a decent proxy for leading lab usage, in addition to the ARR callouts from Anthropic and OpenAI.

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The Key Take-Away: API token growth is surging across the AI industry, a result of agentic enterprise products finally reaching the deployment stage. For most of last year, AI adoption was narrowly focused on deterministic fields like code writing and customer service, but agents like Anthropic Claude Code & Cowork and OpenAI Codex are starting to move the diffusion out to other segments of the economy. Google recently disclosed the latest on API tokens generated at Cloud Next and noted the growth rates are accelerating. We've seen similar metrics from GitHub, pointing to industry-level growth inflecting on the back of Claude Code in mid-December 2025, and not slowing at all since. These disclosures should help calm some of the fears around infrastructure (AI capex) and recent [articles](#) pointing to OpenAI missing 2025 revenue targets. As the level of transparency in AI KPIs increases, especially as IPOs enter the discussion later this year, we expect the "long AI" trade to continue to work.

The Charts & Data: Below we show various charts on data from [Google Cloud Next '26](#), [GitHub activity](#), leading AI lab API run rates, and our updated hyperscaler capex estimates.

"Our first-party models now process more than 16 billion tokens per minute via direct API use by our customers, up from 10 billion last quarter." - Google Cloud Next '26

Google's direct Gemini API has seen rapid growth on the back of new model releases over the past few months, including the Gemini 3.1 Pro and 3.1 Flash-Lite models. The Gemini models offer particularly good price performance, and the recent takeoff in coding agents and app builders is likely contributing to this inflection in tokens processed. In Figure 1, we show how Gemini API token usage has trended over the past 6 months.

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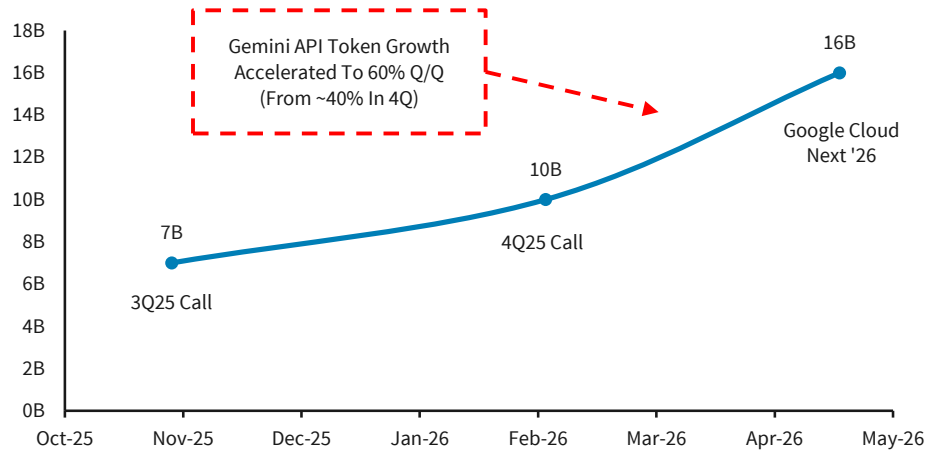
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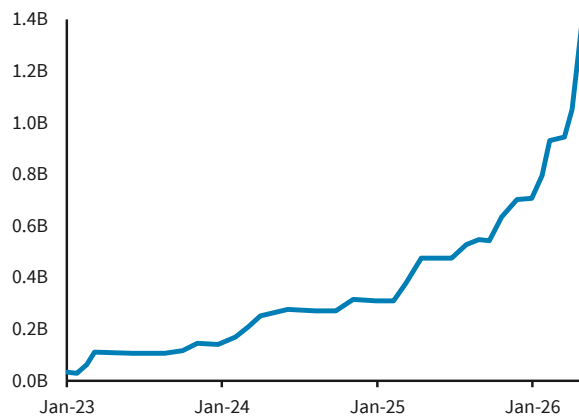
Completed: 30-Apr-26, 22:04 GMT Released: 01-May-26, 04:10 GMT Restricted - External

FIGURE 1. Google Gemini Direct API Tokens Running at ~23T Per Day, up from 10T in October

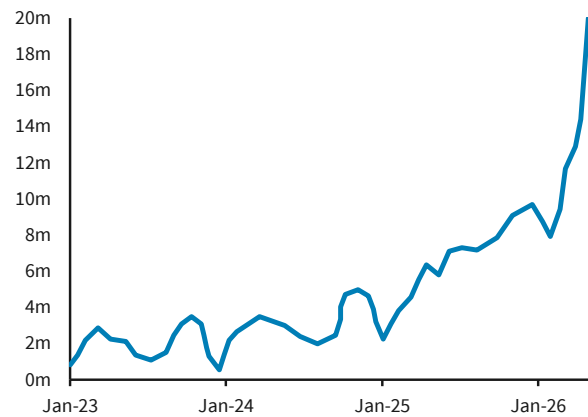
Source: Barclays Research, Company Disclosures

"Since the second half of December 2025, agentic development workflows have accelerated sharply. By nearly every measure, the direction is already clear: repository creation, pull request activity, API usage, automation, and large-repository workloads are all growing quickly." - GitHub

As the largest platform for hosting/collaborating on source code, GitHub has a direct view into how much AI has diffused into software development. A recent activity update showed exponential growth in both commits (changes to code; Figure 2) and new repositories (uploaded projects; Figure 3). Similar to Gemini's increased API usage, this rapid change at GitHub shows that agentic development workflows have accelerated code creation in recent months, and we expect that trend to make its way into other areas of white-collar work shortly.

FIGURE 2. GitHub Commits Are Going Vertical...

Source: Barclays Research, Company Disclosures

FIGURE 3. ... and New GitHub Repositories Too

Source: Barclays Research, Company Disclosures

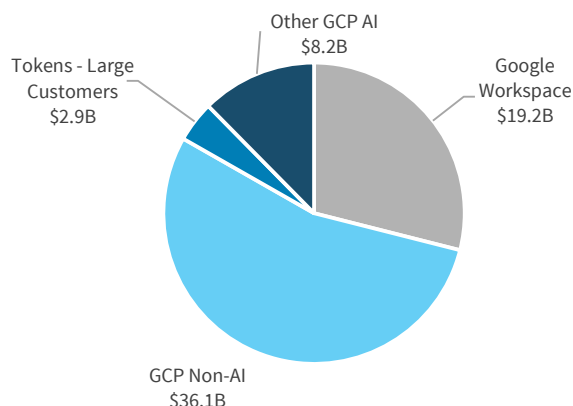
"In fact, nearly 75% of Google Cloud customers are using our AI products to power their businesses. In addition, over the past 12 months, 330 Google Cloud customers each processed more than one trillion tokens, while 35 reached the 10-trillion-token milestone with our models." - Google Cloud Next '26

Customers are also consuming a massive amount of tokens directly on GCP through products like Gemini Enterprise Agent Platform (formerly Vertex AI). In Figure 4, we show how consumption of these "token whales" could translate into revenue, assuming they're using the Gemini 3.1 Pro model (and a 3:1 input:output token ratio – in reality they are likely using a blend of Gemini models, but just for illustrative purposes). In Figure 5, we show where this revenue fits into the Google Cloud reporting segment. Figure 6 shows this breakdown in more detail.

FIGURE 4. GCP Tokens Generated From Large "Whale" Customers....

GCP Tokens - Large Customers		
# Customers	295	35
TTM Tokens Processed	1T	10T
Total Tokens	295T	350T
Blended \$ per 1m Tokens	4.5	4.5
Token Revenue (\$B)	\$1.3B	\$1.6B
Total Token Revenue - Large Customers (\$B)		
% of TTM GCP AI Revenue		26%
% of TTM GCP Revenue		6%
% of TTM Google Cloud Revenue		4%

Trailing 12 Months Thru 1Q26
Source: Barclays Research Estimates, Company Disclosures

FIGURE 5.as a % of Estimated Google Cloud Segment Revenues

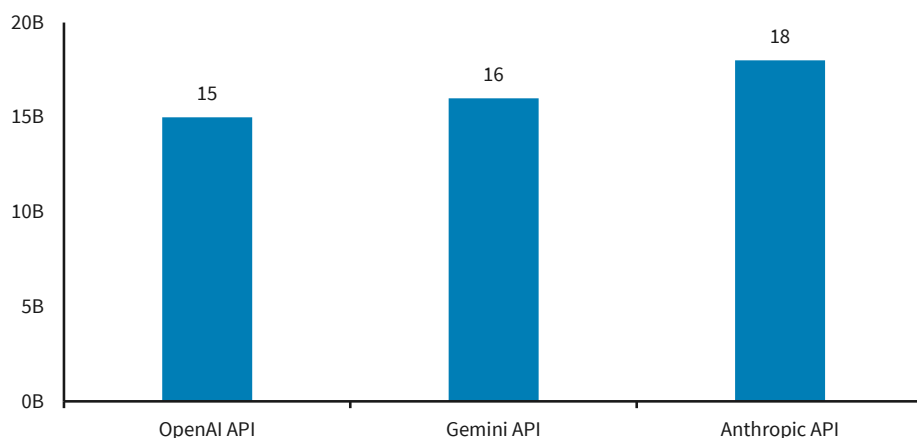
Trailing 12 Months Thru 1Q26
Source: Barclays Research Estimates, Company Disclosures

FIGURE 6. Estimated Google Cloud Segment AI Revenue Breakdown

Google Cloud Breakdown (\$B)	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	TTM
Google Cloud	13.6	15.2	17.7	20.0	66.5
% Y/Y Growth	32%	34%	48%	50%	45%
GCP	9.0	10.4	12.8	15.0	47.2
% Y/Y Growth	43%	45%	67%	74%	64%
% of Google Cloud	66%	69%	73%	75%	71%
GCP AI	1.3	2.1	3.2	4.5	11.1
% of GCP	15%	20%	25%	30%	24%

Source: Barclays Research Estimates, Company Disclosures

In Figure 7, we show how the Google Gemini direct API tokens per minute stacks up to the rest of the field. We assume (although it hasn't been specifically disclosed) that the three leading AI labs are all growing their API businesses at more or less comparable q/q rates during this AI lift-off stage. Anthropic likely has gotten some extra growth on the back of the Opus 4.6/4.7 releases and Claude Code adoption and the generally strong sentiment towards their enterprise products in '26 (based on [Anthropic's funding announcement in February](#), we'd guess the company is seeing Claude Code and Cowork show the fastest revenue bump of any segment right now).

FIGURE 7. Anthropic API Likely Still Leading the Pack

API Tokens Processed Per Minute. See Slide 28 in our recent [State of the Internet slide deck](#).
 Source: Barclays Research, Company Disclosures

"TPU 8t, optimized for training, ... achieves 3x the processing power of Ironwood and delivers up to 2x more performance/Watt. ... TPU 8i, optimized for inference, delivers 80% better performance per dollar for inference than the prior generation, enabling millions of concurrent agents to run cost-effectively." - Google Cloud Next '26

TPU v8 now offers two separate systems: TPU 8t for training and TPU 8i for inference. Some key differences include different network topologies and memory hierarchies. In Figure 8, we compare some of the TPU v8 performance specs to TPU v7 and Nvidia's Rubin chip. We also compare what the peak FLOPs capacity could look like on a 1 GW datacenter scale for each chip. Note that these statistics are "peak performance" and do not take into account the software/networking optimizations that affect performance during real-world workloads.

FIGURE 8. TPU v8 Chip Specs vs. The Field

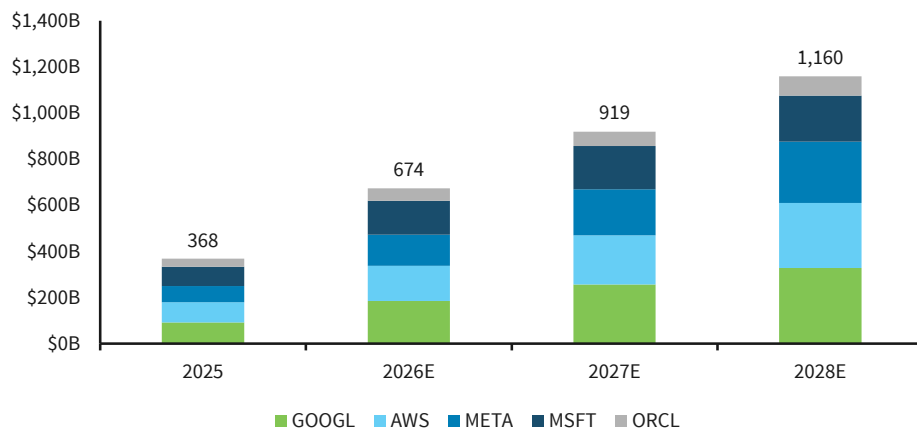
	TPU 7x (Ironwood)	TPU 8t (Training)	TPU 8i (Inference)	Nvidia Rubin
Chip Speed:				
Peak FP4 PFLOPS	4.6	12.6	10.1	50.0
Peak FP8 PFLOPS	4.6	6.3	5.1	17.5
Chip Memory:				
HBM Capacity	192 GB	216 GB	288 GB	288 GB
HBM Bandwidth	7,380 GB/s	6,528 GB/s	8,601 GB/s	22,000 GB/s
Per 1 GW:				
# of Chips	900,000	650,000	800,000	300,000
Peak FP4 EFLOPs Per 1 GW	4,150	8,190	8,080	15,000

TPU v8 Peak FP8 PFLOPS Not Yet Officially Released
 Source: Barclays Research, Company Disclosures

Updated Barclays Hyperscaler Capex Estimates

In the wake of 1Q26 earnings, we show our updated hyperscaler capex estimates in Figure 9. Notably, META increased its guide by \$10B and GOOGL increased by \$5B (mostly from the Intersect acquisition). Barclays raised our total 2027 and 2028 capex estimates by 18% and 26%, respectively (mostly on higher META and MSFT capex).

FIGURE 9. Updated Hyperscaler Capex Post-1Q Prints



AMZN AWS Only; MSFT and ORCL covered by Raimo Lenschow
Source: Barclays Research Estimates, Company Disclosures

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Amazon.com, Inc. (AMZN, 29-Apr-2026, USD 263.04), Overweight/Positive, A/CD/CE/D/E/J/K/L/M/N

Meta Platforms, Inc. (META, 29-Apr-2026, USD 669.12), Overweight/Positive, CD/CE/J/K/M/N

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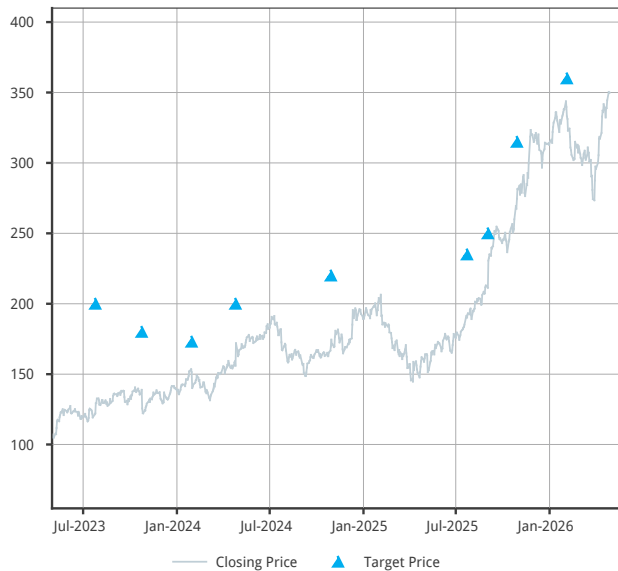
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Industry View: **POSITIVE**

Closing Price: **USD 349.94** (29-Apr-2026)

Rating and Price Target Chart - USD (as of 29-Apr-2026)

Currency=USD



Source: IDC, Barclays Research

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Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target
04-Feb-2026	333.04		360.00
29-Oct-2025	274.57		315.00
02-Sep-2025	212.91		250.00
23-Jul-2025	190.23		235.00
29-Oct-2024	169.68		220.00
25-Apr-2024	156.00		200.00
30-Jan-2024	151.46		173.00
24-Oct-2023	138.81		180.00
25-Jul-2023	122.21		200.00

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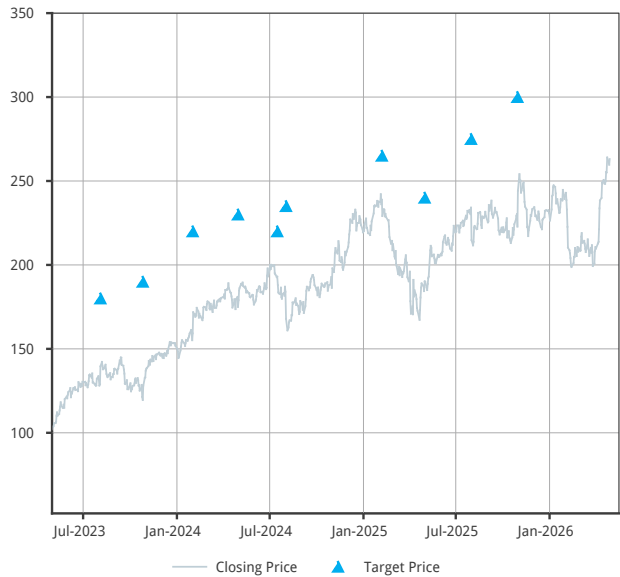
Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **POSITIVE**

Closing Price: **USD 263.04** (29-Apr-2026)

Rating and Price Target Chart - USD (as of 29-Apr-2026)

Currency=USD



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31-Jul-2025	234.11		275.00
01-May-2025	190.20		240.00
06-Feb-2025	238.83		265.00
02-Aug-2024	184.07		235.00
16-Jul-2024	192.72		220.00
30-Apr-2024	175.00		230.00
01-Feb-2024	159.28		220.00
26-Oct-2023	119.57		190.00
04-Aug-2023	128.91		180.00

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Valuation Methodology: We value shares of AMZN using a sum-of-the-parts methodology for its retail and AWS businesses. Our valuation of AMZN's retail business is based on a 20x EBITDA multiple using a blend of our FY27/28 estimates; while we value AWS using a 6x multiple on a blend of our FY27/28 revenue estimates. Our resulting price target is \$330.

Risks which May Impede the Achievement of the Barclays Research Valuation and Price Target: Downside risks in the short term that could negatively impact our model and consensus estimates include 1) greater-than-expected slowdown in AWS against the weak macro backdrop, and hence lower-than-expected OI margins, over a more drawn-out period; 2) further erosion in consumer spending and a persistent input/wage cost inflation could pressure the Retail business. Longer-term risks include the highly competitive ecommerce landscape, increasing shipping costs from same and next-day delivery, which could be a drag on margins, security breaches or frequent downtime in the AWS business, which could slow down public cloud adoption, or execution missteps that could slow growth of the retail business.

Meta Platforms, Inc. (META / META)

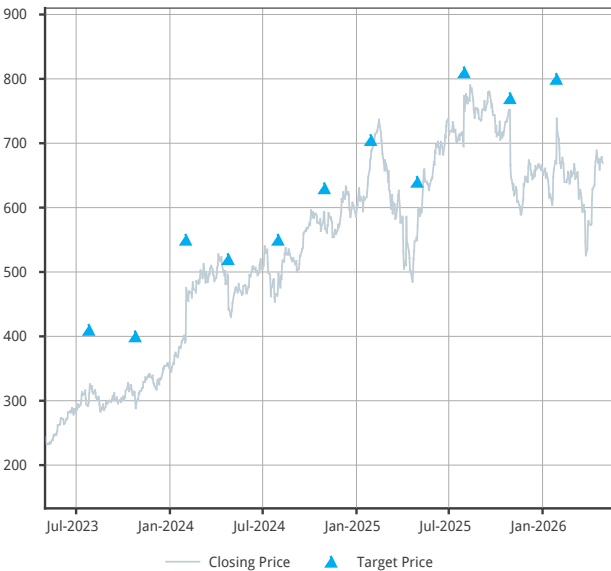
Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **POSITIVE**

Closing Price: **USD 669.12** (29-Apr-2026)

Rating and Price Target Chart - USD (as of 29-Apr-2026)

Currency=USD



Source: IDC, Barclays Research

[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target
28-Jan-2026	668.73		800.00
29-Oct-2025	751.67		770.00
31-Jul-2025	695.21		810.00
30-Apr-2025	549.00		640.00
29-Jan-2025	676.49		705.00
30-Oct-2024	591.80		630.00
31-Jul-2024	474.83		550.00
24-Apr-2024	493.50		520.00
01-Feb-2024	394.78		550.00
25-Oct-2023	299.53		400.00
26-Jul-2023	298.57		410.00

On 30-Apr-2023, prior to any intra-day change that may have been published, the rating for this security was Overweight, and the adjusted price target was 320.00.

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

*This is the closing price referenced in the publication, which may not be the last available closing price at the time of publication.

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Valuation Methodology: Our \$830 price target is based on an average of 25x EPS and 12x EBITDA on our FY27E estimates.

Risks which May Impede the Achievement of the Barclays Research Valuation and Price Target: We believe upside risk exists from FB's innovative products which could drive higher than expected engagement, investor concerns around ad load which could prove to be overblown, and incremental revenue from FB Messenger and WhatsApp. Downside risk could arise from a slowdown in US/Europe, cannibalization of ad revenue from video, and increasing competition.

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